

start rotating the tube for uniform heating. After a few seconds, the tube will feel a little wobbly which means that it's time to bend it. At this point, if you're confident, you can use your bare hands to bend the tube at your desired angle. Since you get some time to make the bend while it's hot, you shouldn't worry much if you can't do it. While you're bending the tubes, you should constantly keep on checking whether the tubing is turning out as you wanted. It's best to insert the work



You can use a regular heat gun to heat and bend the tube

in progress tubes into the compression fittings and verify the angle and length. Once the tubes hardens, it's a little difficult to make them uniformly straight again. This process can be made easier by removing the washer or o-rings inside the compression fittings so that it isn't a tight fit. However, don't forget to add them back otherwise the fluid might leak. If you're confused on where to start, it's always best to follow the route of the liquid flow. So, you should start from the pump to the water blocks then the water block to the radiator. From the radiator you will return back to the reservoir.

If you want accurate angles for your bends, then you can opt for mandrels. They are like stencils for bending where you place the heated tube at the appropriate grooves. You will come across kits where almost all the possible angled mandrels are included. However, they aren't necessary since with some practise, you will be able to bend at 90 and 180-degree angles easily. We'll be going through a more detailed step-by-step guide on how to go about cutting and bending the tubes in the next chapter. 